



SOME SILENCES DON'T BREAK YOU.
THEY INTRODUCE YOU TO YOURSELF.

THE QUIET I STARTED LIVING WITH

A JOURNEY INWARD.
A LIFE REWRITTEN IN SILENCE.

LALIT R. MISHRA

STORIES THAT STAY WITHIN.

THE HUMAN MIND SERIES

BOOK III

THE QUIET I STARTED LIVING WITH

*(A Psychological Reflection on Silence, Identity, Overthinking, and the Invisible
Distance Between Who We Are and Who We Slowly Become)*

Lalit R. Mishra

"Some people lose themselves all at once.

Others disappear so quietly...

they continue living for years without realizing they are no longer fully present.

This book is for those who are ready to notice that quiet."

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The Human Mind Collection

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All thoughts in this book are personal reflections.

Any resemblance to real events is unintentional and subjective.

This is not a guide.

This is an experience.

DISCLAIMER

The Quiet I Started Living With is a reflective work, not professional psychological or medical advice.

Experiences, characters, and conversations may be fictionalized for literary purposes. Any resemblance to real people or events is coincidental.

This book offers no definitive answers. It invites you to observe your own experiences with honesty and curiosity.

Read slowly. Question gently. Meaning is personal.

DEDICATION

To the version of me that kept going without
understanding anything... and still never stopped showing
up.

To the silence that stayed with me when I
couldn't explain myself to anyone.

And to the part of me that
didn't break loudly... just slowly
became quiet.

NOTE FROM THE AUTHOR

This book is not written to explain life.

It is written to document what happens when thoughts
stay longer than emotions, and
silence slowly replaces reaction.

There are no fixed meanings hidden between these pages.
No advice.

No conclusions.

Only observations.

Only inner shifts that were too subtle to notice in real time.

This is not a story of healing.

It is a story of states.

Of phases where you stop recognizing your own patterns,
but
still continue living inside them.

If you find yourself somewhere in these pages, it
is not because the book is about you.

It is because these states are more common than we
admit... just rarely
spoken in words.

PROLOGUE

The Quiet I Started Living With

There is a moment in every life that almost no one remembers.

Not because it is dramatic.

But because nothing seems to happen.

No tragedy announces it.

No celebration marks it.

The world continues unchanged.

Morning still arrives on time.

Messages still get read.

People still ask how you are—and you still answer automatically.

From the outside, nothing shifts.

But somewhere beneath that continuity, something quietly turns inward.

Not the body.

Not the circumstances.

But attention itself.

Without noticing, you begin spending more time inside your mind than inside your life.

At first, it looks harmless.

You replay a conversation from earlier in the day.

You recheck a tone, a pause, a word you shouldn't have said.

You imagine alternative endings to things that already ended.

It feels ordinary. Almost responsible. Like understanding.

Everyone does it.

But the mind does not treat repetition neutrally.

It rewards it.

And what is rewarded is returned to.

Again.

And again.

Until what was once a passing thought becomes a familiar place.

And familiarity slowly changes its meaning.

It starts convincing you that repetition is clarity.

That revisiting something is the same as understanding it.

That was the illusion I never questioned.

I believed I was remembering my life.

In truth, I was reconstructing it—each time slightly differently.

A memory belongs to what happened.

But interpretation survives in the present.

It adjusts itself quietly—according to fear, regret, pride, and expectation.

Until eventually, you are no longer carrying the event itself. You are carrying the version of it your mind refused to stop editing.

There was a night I remember clearly—not because it was important, but because it wasn't.

I was sitting in my room, lights off, phone face down, replaying a conversation that had ended hours ago. Nothing had gone wrong in any visible sense. And yet my mind kept trying to “fix” what could no longer be changed.

That was when I first noticed something strange.

The silence around me was not silent at all.

It was filled.

Not with sound—but with commentary.

Questions without answers.

Replies I should have given.

Explanations no one had asked for.

I used to think silence was outside me.

An empty room.

A late-night street.

A paused world.

I was wrong.

The loudest place I had ever been was inside my own head.
And it wasn't trying to harm me.
It was trying to resolve uncertainty.
Because uncertainty feels unfinished.
And the mind prefers a painful explanation over no
explanation at all.
So it keeps building stories.
Not because it wants suffering—but because it cannot
tolerate gaps.
What is unfinished becomes replayed.
What is replayed becomes familiar.
What is familiar becomes identity.
That is how quietly it happens.
You don't notice the transition.
One day you are thinking.
And one day you are being thought through.
For years, I mistook this for awareness.
But awareness expands life.
This only refined my inner patterns.
There is a kind of comfort hidden inside mental noise.
Not because it feels good—but because it is predictable.

And predictable pain often feels safer than unfamiliar peace.

I did not realize I was choosing familiarity over experience.

Every day.

Without deciding.

Without resistance.

This is not a story about something that broke.

It is about something that slowly replaced everything else.

Presence replaced by interpretation.

Living replaced by replaying.

Experience replaced by explanation.

And the gap between them never felt like a gap.

It felt like thinking.

This book is not an attempt to define silence.

Silence does not need interpretation.

It is an attempt to observe what happens when a person becomes more fluent in their thoughts than in their own life.

When explanation becomes easier than experience.

When surviving thoughts becomes so normal that living quietly stops feeling necessary.

If these pages resemble you in any way, do not rush to find conclusions.

Conclusions end movement.

And this story is not meant to end anything.

Only to notice what has been happening for a long time without being noticed.

Perhaps silence was never the absence of sound.

Perhaps it was the gradual disappearance of the person who once experienced life before translating it.

And perhaps that is why it was so difficult to recognize.

Silence did not arrive.

It was learned.

Slowly.

And eventually... it was lived.

And maybe that is where the story actually begins.

INTRODUCTION

Kabhi notice kiya hai...

ki life hamesha problems ki wajah se heavy nahi lagti.

Kabhi kabhi sab kuch theek hota hai.

Log hote hain.

Kaam chalta rehta hai.

Routine bhi wahi hoti hai.

Aur phir bhi...

andar ek ajeeb sa noise rehta hai.

Ek aisi awaaz jo bahar kisi ko sunai nahi deti.

Par tum uske saath roz uthte ho.

Roz sote ho.

Aur dheere dheere...

use normal maan lete ho.

Hum aksar sochte hain ki hum life experience kar rahe hain.

Par agar thoda aur honestly dekho...

toh shayad hum life se zyada apne thoughts experience kar rahe hote hain.

Ek hi conversation ko baar baar replay karna.

Ek hi memory ko naye angles se dekhna.

Future ke imaginary scenes banana.

Aur phir unhi scenes par emotional reaction dena.
Jaise mind sirf reality nahi jeeta...
wo reality ke andar ek aur reality create karta rehta hai.
Aur sabse dangerous baat?
Ye sab itna gradually hota hai...
ki hume pata bhi nahi chalta kab hum present se zyada
apni interpretation ke saath rehne lage.
Kab humne moments ko jeena kam...
aur unhe explain karna zyada start kar diya.
Shayad isi liye hum itne mentally exhausted rehte hain.
Life ki wajah se nahi.
Us version ki wajah se...
jo humne apne dimaag ke andar bana rakhi hoti hai.
Ye book tumhe positive banna nahi sikhayegi.
Na hi ye bolegi ki overthinking bas stop kar do.
Mind kisi switch ki tarah kaam nahi karta.
Aur healing kisi motivational quote se nahi aati.
Ye book sirf ek invitation hai.
Observe karne ka.
Bina immediately judge kiye.
Bina har feeling ko fix karne ki koshish kiye.
Bina har silence ko bharne ki zarurat mehsoos kiye.

Kyuki kabhi kabhi...
problem thought nahi hota.
Problem ye hota hai...
ki hum har thought ko apni identity bana lete hain.
Aur jab identity thought ke saath attach ho jaati hai...
toh har memory personal lagti hai.
Har rejection permanent lagta hai.
Har uncertainty dangerous lagti hai.
Lekin...
agar tum ek pal ke liye ruk jao...
aur sirf notice karo...
ki tumhare andar kya chal raha hai...
toh shayad tumhe ek aur cheez dikhe.
Thoughts aa rahe hain.
Ja rahe hain.
Emotions bhi aa rahe hain.
Ja rahe hain.
Memories bhi badal rahi hain.
Phir bhi...
kuch hai jo in sab ke beech kabhi change nahi hota.
Ye book usi cheez ke baare mein hai.
Silence ke baare mein nahi.

Us distance ke baare mein...
jo dheere dheere tum aur tumhari real experience ke beech
ban jaata hai.
Aur us possibility ke baare mein...
ki shayad us distance ko force se nahi...
sirf awareness se dekha ja sakta hai.
Ho sakta hai is book mein tumhe answers na mile.
Aur shayad wahi iska purpose bhi hai.
Kyuki kuch questions solve nahi kiye jaate.
Unke saath baithna seekha jaata hai.
Aur kabhi kabhi...
jab tum unhe solve karna chhod dete ho...
tab woh khud dissolve hone lagte hain.
Isliye is book ko jaldi mat padhna.
Har page ko consume mat karna.
Uske saath thoda rukna.
Thoda observe karna.
Aur agar kisi line par tumhe lage...
"Ye toh mere saath bhi hota hai..."
Toh us line ko bas feel karna.
Uska answer dhoondhne ki zarurat nahi.
Kyuki shayad...

ye book tumhe kuch naya sikhane nahi aayi.
Shayad ye sirf tumhe woh dikhane aayi hai...
jo tumhare andar hamesha se tha...
par tum itne busy the usse explain karne mein...
ki kabhi dekh hi nahi paaye.

PHASE I

***THE MIND THAT NEVER
STOPPED SPEAKING***

CHAPTER 1

WHEN YOUR MIND BECOMES THE ONLY PLACE YOU LIVE

Kabhi kabhi dimaag mein itni baatein chal rahi hoti hain...
ki

lagta hai agar abhi koi pooch le, "Kya hua?" toh shayad
main chup ho jaunga.

Isliye nahi ki mujhe pata nahi kya hua.

Isliye kyunki mujhe pata hai.

Bahut kuch pata hai.

Itna ki shuruaat kahan se karni hai, yeh nahi pata. Aur
shayad isi liye kuch log bolna kam nahi karte... woh
explain

karna chhod dete hain.

Maine kabhi notice nahi kiya tha ki insaan dheere dheere
apne andar shift bhi ho sakta hai.

Jaise koi ghar badalta hai.

Bas fark itna hai... mera naya address
mera dimaag ban gaya.

Aur ajeeb baat?

Kisi ko pata bhi nahi chala.

Main hasta bhi raha.
Baat bhi karta raha.
Normal bhi dikhta raha.
Lekin andar kuch aur hi chal raha tha.
Kabhi kabhi main sochta hu...
aakhri baar maine kisi ko apna real version
kab dikhaya tha? Aur phir realise hota hai... mujhe yaad
hi nahi.
Shayad bahut saal pehle.
Shayad kabhi nahi. Kyunki
sach bolun...
mujhe khud nahi pata mera real version hai kaun.
Jo logon ke saath hota hai?
Ya jo raat ko akela hota hai?
Kabhi kabhi mujhe lagta hai main logon ko nahi chhupa
raha.
Main khud se chhupa hua hu.
Aur yeh thought mujhe uncomfortable karta hai.
Kyuki agar main khud ko hi nahi jaanta...
toh phir main expect kis se kar raha hu ki woh mujhe
samjhe?
Maine apne dimaag mein hazaar conversations ki hain.

Hazaar.

Kuch arguments.

Kuch apologies.

Kuch confessions.

Kuch explanations.

Itni baar...

ki kabhi kabhi mujhe genuinely lagta hai ki woh baatein ho chuki hain.

Phir yaad aata hai.

Nahi.

Main toh kabhi bola hi nahi.

Sab kuch mere andar hua tha.

Aur phir ek aur thought aata hai.

Agar meri zindagi ke saare unsaid words likh diye jaayein...
toh

kya woh mere spoken words se zyada honge?

Mujhe lagta hai haan.

Bahut zyada.

Kabhi kabhi main kisi insaan ko yaad nahi karta.

Main us version ko yaad karta hu jo main uske saath tha.

Aur yeh realise karne mein mujhe bahut time laga.

Kyuki mujhe lagta tha main logon ko miss karta hu.

Lekin shayad main un moments ko miss karta hu...
jahan mujhe lagta tha ki main samjha ja raha hu. Ya
kam se kam... akele nahi hu.
Kabhi kabhi main sochta hu...
agar kal subah uthkar mere saare thoughts gayab ho
jaayein... toh
kya main halka feel karunga?
Ya khaali?
Kyuki insaan ajeeb hai.
Jo cheez usse sabse zyada hurt karti hai...
kabhi kabhi woh ussi cheez se apni pehchaan bhi bana
leta hai.
Aur phir usse chhodne se darr lagta hai.
Mujhe lagta tha meri problem loneliness
hai. Phir ek din realise hua... main akela
nahi tha.
Main overloaded tha.
Har memory ko carry karte karte.
Har unsaid baat ko carry karte karte.
Har what if ko carry karte karte.
Aur sabse zyada...
khud ko carry karte karte.

Kuch log kaam se thakte hain.

Kuch log logon se thakte hain.

Aur kuch log...

apne hi dimaag se thak jaate hain.

Main shayad teesri category mein tha.

Ya hu.

Pata nahi.

Kabhi kabhi main sochta hu ki agar koi sach mein meri
help karna chahe... toh main

usse bolunga bhi kya?

Kahan se start karunga?

Kaunsi memory pehle bataunga?

Kaunsa thought explain karunga?

Kaunsi raat?

Kaunsa regret?

Kaunsa version?

Aur phir mujhe samajh aata hai... main
answers nahi dhoondh raha.

Main witness dhoondh raha hu.

Koi jo solve na kare.

Koi jo judge na kare.

Koi jo bas ek baar kahe:

"Haan. Main samajh raha hu."

Aur shayad isi liye kuch log tootne ke baad nahi rote.

Woh bas chup ho jaate hain.

Kyuki emotions khatam nahi hote.

Bas unhe explain karne ki energy khatam ho jaati hai.

Aur phir ek din...

insaan apne hi dimaag mein itna andar chala jaata hai...
ki

bahar ki duniya real lagna band ho jaati hai.

Log dikhte hain.

Awaazein sunai deti hain.

Din nikalte hain.

Lekin andar...

andar sirf thoughts rehte hain.

Aur jab dimaag hi woh jagah ban jaaye jahan tum sabse
zyada rehte ho... toh

dheere dheere woh ghar nahi rehta.

Woh qaid ban jaata hai.

CHAPTER 2

WHY I STOPPED TALKING

Mujhe yaad nahi main kab chup hona shuru hua.

Sach kahu toh mujhe yeh bhi yaad nahi ki maine kab decide kiya tha ki ab baatein apne andar hi rakhni hain.

Bas ek waqt ke baad...

maine batana kam kar diya.

Pehle jab kuch bura lagta tha toh mann karta tha kisi ko bataun.

Kisi ko call karun.

Kisi ko message karun.

Ya bas kisi ke saamne baith kar bol du:

"Yaar, pata nahi kya ho raha hai." Lekin dheere dheere maine notice kiya... har baat explain nahi hoti.

Aur har insaan samajhta bhi nahi.

Kabhi log sunte the... par samajhte nahi the. Kabhi samajhte the... par rukte nahi the. Kabhi rukte the...

par unke paas woh words nahi hote the jo us waqt chahiye hote hain.

Aur phir ek din maine khud se kaha:

"Chhod."

Shayad wahi se shuruaat hui thi.

Ajeeb baat hai...

insaan ek baar mein silent nahi hota.

Woh thoda thoda silent hota hai.

Aaj ek baat nahi batata. Kal ek feeling nahi batata. Phir ek din poora din guzar jaata hai...

aur usne kisi ko apne baare mein kuch nahi bataya hota.

Mere saath bhi shayad aisa hi hua.

Log poochte the:

"Sab theek?"

Aur mere paas jawab hota tha.

Bahut lamba jawab.

Lekin muh se sirf ek word nikalta tha.

"Haan."

Aur us ek word ke peeche kitni cheezein chhupi hoti thi... yeh kisi ko nahi pata tha. Kabhi kabhi mujhe lagta tha... agar

main sach bolna shuru kar du... toh shayad mujhe khud samajh nahi aayega kahan rukna hai.

Itni baatein jama ho gayi thi.

Itne sawaal.

Itni frustrations.

Itni cheezein jo maine kabhi kisi ko batayi hi nahi.

Aur phir dheere dheere ek aur cheez

hui. Main logon se baat karta tha... par

apne baare mein nahi.

Main hasta tha...

par andar kya chal raha hai woh nahi batata tha.

Main conversations mein hota tha...

par present nahi hota tha.

Jaise mera asli version kahin aur reh gaya ho.

Kabhi kabhi mujhe lagta tha ki main kisi ko disturb nahi karna chahta.

Kabhi lagta tha ki koi samjhega nahi.

Kabhi lagta tha ki shayad meri problems utni important hi nahi.

Lekin sach kya tha?

Mujhe nahi pata.

Aur shayad wahi problem thi.

Main khud nahi samajh pa raha tha ki mere andar chal kya raha

hai. Bas itna pata tha... ki main thak gaya hu.

Lekin kis cheez se?

Pata nahi.

Main udaas hu.

Lekin kyun?

Pata nahi.

Main theek nahi hu.

Lekin problem kya hai?

Pata nahi.

Aur jab insaan apni hi feelings explain nahi kar paata...
toh

woh dusron ko explain karna bhi chhod deta hai.

Phir silence comfortable lagne lagta hai.

Dangerous hota hai.

Lekin comfortable.

Kyuki silence mein explain nahi karna padta.

Pretend karna padta hai.

Aur pretend karna...

explain karne se aasaan lagta hai.

Kam se kam shuru mein.

Lekin phir ek waqt aata hai...
jab tum realise karte ho ki tumne sirf baatein chhupayi
nahi.
Tumne khud ko chhupa diya.
Jo cheezein tum feel karte ho.
Jo cheezein tum sochte ho.
Jo cheezein tumhe raat ko jagaye rakhti hain.
Sab kuch.
Aur sabse buri baat?
Kisi ko pata bhi nahi chalta.
Log sochte hain tum strong ho.
Mature ho.
Handle kar lete ho. Lekin reality mein... tum bas aadat
daal chuke hote ho akela handle karne ki.
Aur aadat aur strength mein bahut farq hota hai.
Bahut zyada.
Kabhi kabhi raat ko lagta tha...
kaash koi hota.
Aisa nahi jo solution deta.
Bas koi jo sun leta.
Beech mein roke bina.
Judge kiye bina.

Bas sun leta.

Lekin phir wahi thought aata:

"Chhod."

Aur main phir chup ho jaata.

Shayad isi tarah... dheere

dheere... maine bolna nahi

chhoda. Maine umeed karna

chhod diya... ki koi waqai samajh

payega.

CHAPTER 3

THE THINGS I COULD NEVER EXPLAIN

Kabhi kabhi mujhe lagta hai... main explain karna hi nahi jaanta.

Log sochte hain problem yeh hai ki main bolta nahi. Lekin sach?

Problem yeh hai ki mujhe pata hi nahi hota kya bolun.

Kuch feelings aisi hoti hain jinka naam nahi hota.

Bas weight hota hai.

Aur tum us weight ke saath jeete rehte ho.

Har din.

Har raat.

Jaise pocket mein pathar bhar diye ho kisi ne.

Aur sab pooch rahe ho:

"Tu itna dheere kyun chal raha hai?"

Kabhi kisi ne mujhse poocha: "Tu itna chup kyun rehta hai?" Aur us waqt mujhe realise hua... mere paas answer hi nahi tha.

Main chup kyun rehta hu?

Kyunki main thak gaya hu?

Kyunki mujhe darr lagta hai?

Kyunki mujhe lagta hai koi samjhega nahi?

Ya kyunki main khud ko nahi samajhta?

Pata nahi.

Aur jab answer hi nahi hota... toh explanation

kahan se laun?

Kabhi kabhi main normal baitha hota hu.

Kuch galat bhi nahi hota.

Koi problem bhi nahi hoti.

Lekin andar ek ajeeb si heaviness rehti hai.

Jaise dimaag kisi invisible cheez ko uthaye ghoom raha ho.

Aur sabse frustrating part?

Tum us heaviness ka source bhi nahi bata sakte.

Bas feel kar sakte ho.

Mujhe lagta tha agar main kisi ko sab bata dunga...

toh shayad halka feel karunga. Phir ek din realise

hua... main bataunga kya?

Kahan se shuru karunga?

Us din se jab sab badla tha?

Ya us din se jab maine pretend karna start kiya tha ki sab theek hai?

Ya us din se jab maine pehli baar accept kiya tha ki main theek nahi hu?

Aur phir maine batana hi chhod diya.

Kyunki kuch cheezein explain nahi hoti.

Unhe sirf feel kiya ja sakta hai.

Aur duniya feel nahi karti.

Duniya explanation maangti hai.

"Problem kya hai?"

Kaash mujhe pata hota.

Main khud mahino se wahi dhoond raha hu.

Kabhi kabhi lagta hai main udaas hu.

Phir kisi din hasta hu.

Toh lagta hai shayad udaas nahi tha.

Phir raat aati hai.

Aur wohi khali pan wapas aa jaata

hai. Phir lagta hai... shayad tha.

Aur isi confusion mein mahine nikal jaate hain.

Log kehte hain:

"Khul ke baat kiya kar."

Aur mujhe hamesha yeh line ajeeb lagti hai.

Khul ke?

Kitna khul ke?

Itna ki saamne wala darr jaaye?

Itna ki mujhe khud samajh na aaye main kya bol raha hu?

Ya itna ki saalon se dabayi hui har cheez ek saath bahar aa jaye?

Kabhi kabhi mujhe lagta hai...

main kisi insaan ko nahi dhoond raha.

Main ek jagah dhoond raha hu.

Jahan main finally pretend karna band kar sakun.

Jahan mujhe har sentence explain na karna pade.

Jahan koi yeh na pooche: "Par

hua kya hai?" Kyuki sach toh yeh

hai... kabhi kabhi kuch hua hi

nahi hota.

Aur phir bhi sab kuch toot raha hota hai.

Shayad isi liye kuch baatein aaj tak mere andar hain.

Na maine unhe likha.

Na bola.

Na samjhaya.

Bas uthaye rakha.

Jaise koi purana bojh.

Jiski aadat toh pad gayi hai... par

weight ab bhi utna hi hai.

CHAPTER 4

THE CONVERSATIONS THAT NEVER HAPPENED

Kabhi kabhi mujhe lagta hai... meri zindagi ki sabse lambi conversations

un logon ke saath hui hain... jinse maine asal mein kuch kaha hi nahi.

Sab kuch dimaag ke andar hota tha.

Poori scene ready.

Main.

Woh.

Ek jagah. Aur

finally... main bol

raha hu.

Jo saalon se nahi bol paaya.

Jo har baar gale tak aakar ruk gaya.

Jo har baar "chhod" ke peeche dab gaya.

Kabhi kabhi main imagine karta tha...

ki woh pooch rahi hai:

"Sach batao, hua kya tha?" Aur

us moment mein... mere paas

answer hota tha.

Pehli baar.

Na gussa.

Na ego.

Na explanation.

Bas sach

Lekin ajeeb baat yeh hai... real life mein kisi ne kabhi woh sawaal poocha hi nahi.

Aur shayad isi liye main aaj tak jawab deta rehta hu.

Apne dimaag mein.

Kuch logon ko lagta hai overthinking future ke baare mein hoti hai.

Meri overthinking aksar past ke baare mein thi.

Woh conversations jo ho sakti thi.

Woh moments jo bach sakte the.

Woh misunderstandings jo shayad clear ho sakti thi.

Main baar baar wahi scene kholta tha. Jaise dimaag ko umeed ho... ki is baar ending badal jayegi.

Is baar main sahi words choose karunga.

Is baar woh samajh jayegi.

Is baar koi uth kar nahi jaayega.

Is baar baat adhuri nahi rahegi.
Lekin ending har baar wahi rehti thi.
Reality har baar jeet jaati thi.
Aur phir mujhe samajh aaya...
main us insaan ko nahi pakad kar baitha tha.
Main possibility ko pakad kar baitha tha.
Us version ko...
jahan sab theek ho sakta tha.
Us conversation ko...
jahan sab clear ho sakta
tha. Us ending ko... jo
kabhi mili hi nahi.
Kabhi kabhi mujhe uski yaad nahi aati thi.
Mujhe us conversation ki yaad aati thi... jo kabhi
hui hi nahi.
Woh explanation...
jo main kabhi de nahi paaya.
Woh questions...
jo usne kabhi pooche nahi.
Woh silence... jo hum dono ke beech itna
bada ho gaya... ki ek din usne sab kuch kha
liya.

Aur shayad isi liye kuch stories khatam nahi hoti.
Kyuki unka ending missing nahi hota.
Unki conversation missing hoti hai.
Log closure dhoondte hain.
Main bhi dhoondta tha. Phir ek
din realise hua...
main closure nahi dhoond raha.
Main ek mauka dhoond raha hu.
Ek last conversation.
Ek last explanation. Ek
last chance ki... is baar
koi samajh le.
Lekin life har kisi ko woh chance nahi deti.
Aur yahi baat sabse zyada dard deti hai.
Kyunki kuch chapters isliye adhure nahi rehte...
ki humne likhna chhod diya. Kuch chapters
adhure rehte hain...
kyunki hume kabhi bolne ka mauka hi nahi mila.

PHASE II

***WHEN SILENCE
BECOMES YOUR
LANGUAGE***

CHAPTER 5

WHEN YOU STOP RECOGNIZING YOURSELF

Mujhe exact din yaad nahi...

jab maine khud ko khona shuru kiya.

Shayad kisi ko yaad nahi hota.

Insaan ko woh din yaad rehte hain jab uska dil tootta hai.

Lekin woh din yaad nahi rehta...

jab uski personality tootni shuru hoti hai.

Kabhi kabhi main purani photos dekhta hu.

Aur mujhe un logon ki yaad nahi aati jo un photos mein hain.

Mujhe us ladke ki yaad aati hai jo photo mein khada hai.

Kyunki mujhe woh ladka yaad hai.

Aur phir bhi nahi hai.

Usse cheezon ka excitement hota tha.

Woh bina soche message bhej deta tha.

Bina darr ke attach ho jaata tha.

Bina calculate kiye trust kar leta tha.

Usse nahi pata tha...

ki ek din woh har word ko bolne se pehle do baar sochega.

Har feeling ko feel karne se pehle analyse karega.
Aur har insaan se milne se pehle distance maintain karega.
Kabhi kabhi mujhe lagta hai... main
overthinking se nahi thaka.
Main khud se thak gaya hu.
Har waqt alert rehna.
Har waqt strong dikhna.
Har waqt yeh pretend karna ki sab control mein hai.
Ek point ke baad yeh exhausting ho jaata hai.
Bahut zyada.
Sab log kehte hain:
"Tu change ho gaya."
Aur mujhe sabse zyada gussa is baat par nahi aata.
Mujhe gussa is baat par aata hai...
ki woh sahi hote hain.
Main change ho gaya hu.
Aur mujhe nahi pata kab.
Mujhe yaad nahi ki maine kab openly baat karna chhoda.
Kab maine logon ko distance par rakhna shuru kiya.
Kab maine har situation ke worst outcome ke liye mentally
prepare rehna shuru kiya.
Bas itna pata hai...

ki ab yeh sab normal lagta hai.
Aur shayad yahi sabse dangerous part hai.
Jab pain normal lagne lage.
Jab silence normal lagne lage.
Jab loneliness normal lagne lage.
Jab tumhara broken version tumhe original version se zyada familiar lagne lage.
Kabhi kabhi mujhe darr lagta hai.
Us cheez se nahi jo mere saath hui.
Us cheez se jo uske baad mere andar hui.
Kahin main itna adapt na kar jaun...
ki mujhe yaad hi na rahe main pehle kaun tha.
Kahin ek din main purani photos dekhun... aur us ladke ko stranger ki tarah dekhu.
Kahin ek din mujhe yaad hi na rahe... ki bina fear ke trust karna kaisa lagta tha.
Bina overthinking ke sona kaisa lagta tha.
Bina apne thoughts se ladhe ek din guzar jaana kaisa lagta tha.
Aur sabse uncomfortable thought?
Mujhe kabhi kabhi lagta hai...
ki shayad main heal nahi hona chahta.

Shayad main sirf yeh prove karna chahta hu... ki
jo kuch hua tha...
usne mujhe itna affect nahi kiya.
Lekin agar aisa hai...
toh phir main aaj bhi uske baare mein kyun sochta hu?
Aaj bhi khud ko kyun analyse karta hu?
Aaj bhi purane versions ko kyun dhoondta hu?
Shayad isliye kyunki sach mujhe pata hai.
Kuch cheezein sirf hurt nahi karti.
Woh insaan ko re-shape kar deti hain.
Aur shayad meri problem yeh nahi hai ki main badal gaya.
Meri problem yeh hai...
ki mujhe aaj tak samajh nahi aaya...
ki jo main ban gaya hu...
kya main waise banna bhi chahta tha?

CHAPTER 6

THE VERSION OF ME NOBODY EVER KNEW

Mujhe bahut time tak lagta raha ki log mujhe samajhte nahi.

Main is baat se irritate bhi hota tha.

Kabhi kabhi hurt bhi.

Aur kabhi kabhi mujhe sach mein lagta tha ki shayad meri life mein koi aisa insaan hai hi nahi jo

mujhe poori tarah samajh sake.

Phir ek din pata nahi kyun...

maine khud se ek sawaal poocha.

Agar koi mujhe samajhta nahi...

toh maine kitni baar kisi ko mauka diya?

Aur wahi jagah thi jahan mera poora argument toot gaya.

Kyunki sach yeh tha...

main logon ko apne baare mein batata tha.

Lekin sirf utna...

jitna comfortable lagta tha.

Jo cheezein easy thi...

main unke baare mein bol deta tha.

Jo cheezein funny thi... unpar joke
maar deta tha.

Jo cheezein normal thi... unhe share
kar deta tha.

Lekin jo cheezein sach mein important thi...
unpar main chup ho jaata tha.

Aur phir mujhe lagta tha ki log mujhe nahi jaante.

Aaj sochta hu toh ajeeb lagta hai.

Main ek locked room mein baitha tha.

Darwaza khud band kiya tha.

Chabi bhi mere paas thi.

Aur phir main complain kar raha tha ki koi andar kyun
nahi aata.

Kabhi kabhi mujhe lagta hai... main
logon se honest tha.

Phir main purani conversations yaad karta hu.

Aur realise hota hai... main
honest tha.

Bas complete honest nahi tha.

Difference bahut bada hai.

Main bata deta tha ki main tired hu.

Yeh nahi batata tha kis cheez se.

Main bol deta tha ki sab normal hai.

Yeh nahi batata tha ki normal feel karna mujhe yaad bhi nahi.

Main kehta tha ki mujhe farq nahi padta.

Yeh nahi batata tha ki wahi cheez mujhe raat bhar jagaye rakhti hai.

Aur dheere dheere... yeh
aadat ban gayi.

Itni purani aadat...

ki mujhe khud yaad nahi raha ki main kya chhupa raha hu.

Sab log ek version jaante the mera.

Woh jo reply karta tha.

Woh jo hasta tha.

Woh jo bolta tha:

"Sab theek hai."

Lekin woh poora version nahi tha.

Poora version kabhi room mein aata hi nahi tha.

Woh sirf mere saath rehta tha.

Wahi version jo ek simple sentence ko dus baar analyse karta

tha. Wahi version jo kuch logon ko bhool jaana chahta tha... aur

unhe yaad rakhne ke reasons bhi dhoondhta rehta tha.
Wahi version jo move on karna chahta tha...
lekin kuch cheezon ko khatam maan nahi paata tha.
Aur sabse ajeeb baat?
Mujhe nahi lagta main kisi aur se jhooth bol raha tha.
Mujhe lagta hai main khud ko convince kar raha tha.
Ki agar main kisi thought ko loud nahi bolunga...
toh shayad woh itna real nahi lagega.
Ki agar main kisi feeling ka naam nahi lunga... toh
shayad mujhe usse deal nahi karna padega.
Lekin feelings naam na lene se gayab nahi hoti.
Woh bas background mein chalti rehti hain.
Aur ek din tum realise karte ho...
ki tumhari aadhi energy un cheezon ko ignore karne mein
ja rahi hai...
jinhe tumne kabhi accept hi nahi kiya.
Kabhi kabhi mujhe lagta hai... main
connection chahta tha.
Lekin vulnerability nahi.
Main chahta tha koi mujhe samjhe.
Lekin main explain nahi karna chahta tha.
Main chahta tha koi ruk jaye.

Lekin main kisi ko itna paas aane nahi deta tha ki woh ruk sake.

Aur phir jab log door ho jaate the...

main sochta tha ki sab chale kyun jaate hain.

Aaj yeh likhte hue...

mujhe lagta hai main logon se kam...

khud se zyada confuse tha.

Main nahi jaanta tha mujhe kya chahiye.

Bas itna jaanta tha...

ki jo mere paas hai woh nahi chahiye.

Aur jo chahiye...

usse lene ki himmat nahi thi.

Shayad isi liye meri life ka ek version sabne dekha.

Aur ek version kisi ne nahi.

Na doston ne.

Na un logon ne jo mere close the.

Aur shayad... na

maine khud.

Mujhe lagta tha meri problem yeh hai ki koi mujhe poori tarah nahi jaanta.

Aaj lagta hai...

sabse pehle mujhe khud hi mujhe jaan lena chahiye tha.

CHAPTER-7

I DON'T KNOW WHAT I'M WAITING FOR

Ek time tha jab mujhe lagta tha mujhe exactly pata hai
main kya chahta hu.

Main chahta tha sab theek ho jaye.

Bas.

Ek conversation.

Ek explanation.

Ek misunderstanding clear.

Aur shayad sab wapas normal ho jaye.

Us waqt mujhe lagta tha problem simple hai.

Bas situation kharab hai.

Log kharab nahi.

Feelings kharab nahi.

Connection kharab nahi.

Bas situation.

Aur main bahut time tak isi thought ko pakad ke baitha
raha.

Kyunki agar problem situation thi... toh ek
din woh solve ho sakti thi.

Aur agar woh solve ho sakti thi... toh mujhe
wait karna chahiye tha.
Isliye maine wait kiya.
Pehle har din.
Phir har week.
Phir har month.
Aur dheere dheere mujhe wait karne ki aadat ho gayi.
Sabse ajeeb baat?
Ek point ke baad mujhe yaad bhi nahi raha...
main kis cheez ka wait kar raha hu.
Kabhi lagta tha main uska wait kar raha hu.
Phir main khud se poochta:
"Agar woh aaj saamne aa jaye toh?"
Aur mere paas answer nahi hota.
Sach bolu...
main us insaan ke baare mein kam sochta tha.
Main us version ke baare mein zyada sochta tha jo mere
dimaag ne bana rakha tha.
Woh version jo sab samajh leta.
Woh version jo sab explain kar deta.
Woh version jahan kisi ko kuch prove nahi karna padta.
Aur phir mujhe realise hua...

main reality ko miss nahi kar raha tha.
Main ek imagination ko miss kar raha tha.
Aur imagination ki problem yeh hoti hai...
usme kabhi flaws nahi hote.
Real log disappoint karte hain.
Imaginary versions nahi.
Real conversations awkward hoti hain.
Imaginary conversations perfect hoti haii
Real endings incomplete hoti hain
Imaginary endings hamesha satisfy karti hai
Shayad isi liye mera dimaag baar baar wahi jaata tha.
Kyunki imagination mein sab control mein tha.
Reality mein nahi.
Kabhi kabhi main imagine karta tha... ki
ek din sab wapas normal ho jayega.
Phir ek aur thought aata tha
Normal?
Kaunsa normal?
Woh jo pehle tha?
Ya woh jo maine apne dimaag mein bana liya tha?
Kyunki jitna zyada waqt guzra... utna zyada mujhe realise
hua... ki main sirf kisi insaan ka wait

nahi kar raha tha.

Main time ka wait kar raha tha. .

Main chahta tha koi mujhe woh version wapas de de...

jo cheezein tootne se pehle tha.

Lekin waqt ek ajeeb cheez hai.

Woh logon ko wapas nahi deta.

Version bhi nahi.

Woh sirf aage badhta rehta hai.

Aur shayad meri frustration ka asli reason yahi tha.

Main future se kuch maang raha tha...

jo sirf past de sakta tha.

Aur past ke paas dene ke liye kuch nahi bacha tha.

Ek din maine khud se poocha:

"Agar tujhe woh conversation mil bhi gayi toh?"

"Kya sab theek ho jayega?"

Aur pehli baar...

main confidently "haan" nahi bol paaya.

Kyunki andar kahin mujhe pata tha... ki

mujhe conversation nahi chahiye.

Mujhe explanation nahi chahiye.

Mujhe closure bhi nahi chahiye.

Mujhe jo chahiye tha....

woh kisi ke paas tha hi nahi
Mujhe time reverse karna tha.
Mujhe un moments mein wapas jaana tha...
jab cheezein complicated nahi thi.
Jab mujhe har cheez analyse nahi karni padti thi.
Jab future itna heavy nahi lagta tha.
Jab kisi naam ko sunke dimaag itna loud nahi ho jaata
tha.
Aur tab mujhe samajh aaya...
ki main impossible cheez ka wait kar raha thaa....
Shayad isi liye main itna thak gaya.
Kyunki insaan jab kisi real cheez ka wait karta hai...
toh ek din answer mil jaata hai.
Lekin jab insaan impossible cheez ka wait karta hai...
toh woh sirf wait karta rehta hai.
Kabhi kabhi mujhe lagta hai...
main move on nahi kar pa raha tha.
Lekin agar main poori honesty se bolu...
toh shayad main move on se nahi darr raha tha.
Main accept karne se darr raha tha.
Accept karne se...

ki kuch stories waise khatam hoti hain jaisa hum nahi chahte.

Koi final message nahi.

Koi perfect ending nahi.

Koi last explanation nahi

Bas ek din sab ruk jaata hai.

Aur tum bahut der baad realise karte ho...

ki story khatam ho chuki thi.

Sirf tum uske last page par baithe hue the.

Aur shayad isi liye aaj bhi jab main khud se poochta hu:

"Tu kis cheez ka wait kar raha tha?"

Toh mere paas perfect answer nahi hota.

Bas itna pata hai...

ki main kisi insaan ko pakad kar nahi baitha tha.

Main ek possibility ko pakad kar baitha tha.

Aur possibilities kabhi officially marti nahi

Woh bas dheere dheere insaan ke andar ghar bana leti hain.

Aur phir ek din tum realise karte ho...

ki tum zindagi nahi jee rahe.

Tum ek alternate version ka wait kar rahe ho...

jo kabhi aane wala hi nahi.

.

.

Woh bas dheere dheere insaan ke andar ghar bana leti hain.

Aur phir ek din tum realise karte ho...

ki tum zindagi nahi jee rahe.

Tum ek alternate version ka wait kar rahe ho...

jo kabhi aane wala hi nahi.

CHAPTER 8

AFTER I STOPPED WAITING

Mujhe lagta tha meri problem wait karna hai.

Sach mein.

Mujhe lagta tha jis din main wait karna band kar dunga...
ussi din sab theek ho jayega.

Jis din main peeche dekhna band kar dunga.

Jis din main possibilities ke baare mein sochna band kar dunga.

Jis din main "what if" ko chhod dunga.

Us din shayad main free ho jaunga.

Bahut time tak main isi thought par believe karta raha.

Phir ek din...

pata nahi kaise...

wait khatam ho gaya.

Na koi announcement hui.

Na koi dramatic moment.

Na koi realization.

Bas ek din maine notice kiya... main
dekh nahi raha.

Main expect nahi kar raha.

Main imagine nahi kar raha.
Aur pehli baar mujhe laga... shayad
yeh khatam ho gaya.
Lekin jo cheez uske baad hui... uske
liye main ready nahi tha.
Relief nahi aaya.
Silence aaya.
Ek ajeeb sa silence.
Jaise bahut time se background mein koi machine chal
rahi thi...
aur achanak band ho gayi.
Aur phir mujhe pehli baar room ki khamoshi sunai di.
Main bahut time tak samajhta raha...
ki mera struggle us cheez se tha jiska main wait kar raha
tha.
Lekin wait khatam hone ke baad realise hua...
mera struggle us cheez se tha jo main avoid kar raha tha.
Khud ko.
Kyunki jab tak main wait kar raha tha... mere
paas focus karne ke liye kuch tha.
Ek possibility.
Ek memory.

Ek unfinished chapter.
Ab woh nahi tha.
Aur ab mujhe apni life dekhni thi.
Wahi life jise maine kitni baar postpone kiya tha.
Wahi questions jinke answers maine kabhi dhoonde hi nahi.
Kabhi kabhi mujhe lagta hai...
main move on nahi karna chahta tha.
Main distract rehna chahta tha.
Kyunki distraction comfortable hoti hai.
Tum kisi aur ke baare mein soch sakte ho.
Kisi aur ki absence ke baare mein.
Kisi aur ki mistakes ke baare mein.
Lekin jab woh sab hat jaata hai... tab
tumhare paas sirf tum bachte ho.
Aur har insaan khud ke saath comfortable nahi hota.
Main bhi nahi tha.
Mujhe lagta tha...
agar woh chapter close ho gaya...
toh meri life automatically better lagne lagegi.
Lekin chapter close hua... aur
main wahi tha.

Wahi insecurities.

Wahi confusion.

Wahi habits.

Aur pehli baar mujhe realise hua...

ki kuch problems us chapter ne create nahi ki thi.

Kuch problems pehle se mere andar thi.

Main bas unhe dekh nahi raha tha.

Yeh realization achha nahi tha.

Kyunki us point tak mere paas ek villain tha.

Ek situation.

Ek memory.

Ek loss.

Ab mere paas kuch nahi tha.

Sirf ek mirror tha.

Aur mirror kabhi kabhi bahut cruel hota hai.

Woh excuses nahi maanta.

Woh bas dikhata hai.

Aur mujhe jo dikh raha tha...

woh mujhe pasand nahi aa raha tha.

Main thak gaya tha.

Lekin sirf kisi aur ki wajah se nahi.

Khud ki wajah se bhi.

Khud se bhaagte bhaagte.
Khud ko samjhayе bina.
Khud ko ignore karte karte.
Ek point ke baad insaan kisi aur ko nahi...
khud ko lose kar deta hai.
Aur shayad mere saath bhi wahi hua tha.
Mujhe lagta tha meri life ka sabse difficult part wait karna
tha.
Aaj lagta hai...
sabse difficult part uske baad shuru hua.
Kyunki wait ke baad...
koi direction automatically nahi milti.
Koi purpose automatically nahi milta.
Koi naya version automatically create nahi hota.
Tumhe khud banana padta hai.
Aur sach kahu...
mujhe nahi pata tha kaise.
Main pehli baar us jagah khada tha... jahan
peeche ja nahi sakta tha.
Aur aage ka raasta clearly dikh nahi raha tha.
Aur shayad adulthood ka ek hidden part yahi hai.
Bahut baar tumhe exact answer nahi milta.

Bas ek din tum decide karte ho... ki
confusion ke saath bhi chalna hai.
Aur wahi din...
actual beginning hoti hai.
Ending nahi. Beginning.

PHASE III

***THE WEIGHT OF THE
UNSEEN***

CHAPTER 9

I DIDN'T KNOW WHO TO BECOME

Jab main peeche dekhna band kar raha tha... tab mujhe laga tha life thodi easy ho jayegi.

Mujhe lagta tha sabse difficult part wait karna tha.

Phir wait khatam ho gaya.

Aur mujhe samajh aaya...

main galat problem solve kar raha tha.

Kyunki ab mere paas ek aur sawaal khada tha.

Ab kya?

Yeh bahut simple lagta hai.

Lekin shayad meri life ke sabse uncomfortable questions mein se ek tha.

Ab kya?

Kahan jaana hai?

Kya karna hai?

Kya banna hai?

Aur sabse honest answer yeh tha...

mujhe nahi pata tha.

Main bahut time tak survival mode mein tha.

Bas din nikal rahe the.

Thoughts handle ho rahe the.
Memories handle ho rahi thi.
Emotions handle ho rahe the.
Aur itna sab handle karte karte...
maine future ke baare mein sochna hi band kar diya tha.
Kyunki future imagine karne ke liye energy chahiye hoti hai.
Aur mere paas us waqt bas energy bach rahi thi.
Dreams nahi.
Kabhi kabhi log poochte the:
"Five years baad khud ko kahan dekhte ho?"
Aur main hasta tha.
Isliye nahi ki question funny tha.
Isliye kyunki mujhe next month bhi clear nahi dikhta tha.
Five years bahut door ki baat thi.
Mujhe lagta tha har kisi ke paas koi direction hoti hai.
Koi version hota hai...
jaisa woh banna chahta hai.
Mere paas nahi tha.
Ya shayad tha.
Lekin main usse dekh nahi pa raha tha.

Kyunki main itne time tak yeh sochta raha ki mujhe kya lose hua...

ki maine yeh sochna hi band kar diya ki mujhe kya create karna hai.

Aur dono cheezein alag hoti hain.

Lose karna past ka question hai.

Create karna future ka.

Main pehle wale mein atka hua tha.

Kabhi kabhi mujhe lagta tha...

main change ho gaya hu.

Phir main sochta tha...

nahi.

Shayad main sirf thak gaya hu.

Phir lagta tha...

nahi.

Shayad main grow hua hu.

Aur phir kuch din baad...

sab wapas confusing lagne lagta tha.

Main decide hi nahi kar paata tha...

ki jo insaan aaj mirror mein dikh raha hai... woh

healing kar raha hai...

ya bas adapt kar raha hai.

Kyunki dono bahar se same dikhte hain.
Aur shayad isi liye main itna lost feel karta tha.
Mujhe pata nahi tha main kaun hu.
Aur usse bhi zyada dangerous baat...
mujhe pata nahi tha main kaun banna chahta hu.
Ek waqt tha jab mujhe lagta tha life choices ki problem hai.
Aaj lagta hai...
clarity ki problem thi.
Tum kuch choose kaise karoge...
jab tumhe khud nahi pata tum kis direction mein dekh
rahe ho?
Kabhi kabhi main logon ko dekhta tha.
Unke plans.
Unke goals.
Unka confidence.
Aur mujhe genuinely curiosity hoti thi.
Yeh log itne sure kaise hain?
Main toh apne thoughts ke baare mein sure nahi tha.
Apne emotions ke baare mein sure nahi tha.
Apne future ke baare mein kaise ho jaata?
Phir dheere dheere ek realization aaya.
Shayad problem yeh nahi thi ki mujhe answer nahi pata.

Shayad problem yeh thi ki main answer aane ka wait kar raha tha.

Jaise ek din uthunga...

aur achanak sab clear ho jayega.

Jaise identity koi notification hai... jo

ek din phone screen par aa jayegi.

Lekin aisa nahi hota.

Bahut saari cheezein clarity se nahi...

movement se milti hain.

Pehle chalna padta hai.

Baad mein samajh aata hai ki kahan ja rahe the.

Aur mujhe lagta hai...

yeh baat accept karne mein mujhe bahut time laga.

Kyunki main certainty chahta tha.

Main guarantee chahta tha.

Main pehle answer chahta tha.

Phir action.

Life ulta kaam karti hai.

Pehle action.

Phir answer.

Aur shayad isi liye main itne time tak wahi khada raha.

Mujhe perfect direction chahiye thi.

Jabki mujhe bas pehla step lena tha.
Aaj bhi mere paas saare answers nahi hain.
Aaj bhi mujhe exact nahi pata main kaun banunga.
Lekin pehli baar...
mujhe yeh nahi lagta ki mujhe pehle sab pata hona
chahiye.
Shayad kuch cheezein raste mein samajh aati hain.
Aur shayad identity bhi unmein se ek hai.
Kyunki kabhi kabhi..
tum khud ko dhoondhte nahi
Tum khud ko banate ho.
.

CHAPTER 10

THE PERSON I PRETENDED TO BE

Mujhe bahut time tak lagta raha ki main bas adapt kar raha hu.

Situation ke hisaab se.

Logon ke hisaab se.

Life ke hisaab se.

Aur shayad main sach mein adapt hi kar raha tha.

Problem adaptation nahi thi.

Problem yeh thi... ki ek point ke baad mujhe yaad hi nahi raha... ki adaptation kahan khatam hui thi.

Aur acting kahan shuru hui thi.

Main fake nahi tha.

Kam se kam mujhe aisa nahi lagta.

Main jhooth bolne wala insaan bhi nahi tha.

Lekin phir bhi...

kuch toh tha jo natural nahi lagta tha.

Jaise main har jagah thoda alag insaan ban jaata tha.

Kisi ke saamne funny. Kisi ke saamne mature.

Kisi ke saamne detached.

Kisi ke saamne completely fine.

Aur yeh sab versions itne time tak saath chalte rahe... ki mujhe samajh nahi aaya... asli wala kaunsa hai.

Kabhi kabhi mujhe lagta tha...

main logon ko disappoint karne se darra hu.

Phir baad mein realise hua...

main unki expectations todne se zyada...

unki expectations ke bina rehne se darra tha.

jab log tumse kuch expect karte hain... toh

kam se kam tumhe ek role mil jaata hai.

Ek character.

Ek script.

Aur script follow karna aasaan hota hai.

Khud se decide karna mushkil.

Mujhe yaad hai kitni baar main woh cheezein karta tha...

jo mujhe karni nahi thi.

Aur jab koi poochta:

"Tu theek hai na?"

Main automatically bol deta:

"Haan."

Na isliye ki main theek tha.

Na isliye ki main jhooth bol raha tha.
Bas isliye kyunki mujhe pata tha saamne wala kis answer
ki expectation kar raha hai.
Aur dheere dheere...
maine notice karna band kar diya...
ki mujhe actually kya feel ho raha hai.
Main bas woh answer dene laga...
jo situation ko smooth rakhe.
Woh reaction jo conflict avoid kar de.
Woh version jo manageable ho.
Manageable.
Yeh word mujhe bahut time baad samajh aaya.
Mujhe lagta hai main khush dikhne ki acting kam karta
tha.
Manageable dikhne ki zyada.
Jaise duniya ko ek easy version chahiye tha.
Aur main wahi provide karta raha.
Kyunki easy versions logon ko comfortable rakhte haii
Aur mujhe sawaalon se darr lagta tha.
Kahin koi pooch na le:
"Tu actually kaisa hai?"
Kahin mujhe khud answer na dena pad jaye.

Kabhi kabhi mujhe lagta hai...
main apni life ka audience ban gaya tha.
Main khud ko perform karte hue dekh raha tha
Aur mujhe sawaalon se darr lagta tha.
Kahin koi pooch na le:
"Tu actually kaisa hai?"
Kahin mujhe khud answer na dena pad jaye.
Kabhi kabhi mujhe lagta hai...
main apni life ka audience ban gaya tha.
Main khud ko perform karte hue dekh raha tha.
Ek version jo logon ko samajh aata tha.
Ek version jo explain nahi karna padta tha.
Ek version jo accept kiya ja sakta tha.
Aur shayad isi liye. jab main akela hota
tha... toh mujhe ajeeb sa disconnect feel
hota tha.
jab main akela hota tha... toh mujhe ajeeb
sa disconnect feel hota tha.
Kyunki performance khatam ho jaati thi.
Aur phir room mein sirf main bachta tha.
Aur sach kahu...

mujhe us insaan ko samajhne mein bahut mushkil hoti thi.

Main itne time tak roles play karta raha... ki mujhe original script yaad hi nahi rahi.

Main itne time tak adjust karta raha... ki mujhe preferences yaad nahi rahi.

Main itne time tak fit hone ki koshish karta raha... ki mujhe pata hi nahi chala... main kis jagah belong karta hu.

Aur shayad isi liye Chapter 9 ka sawaal itna difficult tha.

"Mujhe kaun banna hai?

Kyunki usse pehle mujhe yeh samajhna tha... ki main itne saalon se kaun ban kar jee raha tha

Aur pehli baar mujhe laga...

shayad healing ka matlab sirf pain se recover karna nahi hota.

Aur pehli baar mujhe laga...

shayad healing ka matlab sirf pain se recover karna nahi hota

Kabhi kabhi healing ka matlab yeh bhi hota hai...

ki tum dheere dheere un roles ko utaarna shuru karo...

jinhe pehen pehen kar tum khud ko bhool gaye the

Mujhe aaj bhi poori tarah nahi pata asli main kaun hu.

Lekin ek cheez pata chal gayi.

Main woh insaan nahi hu...

jo main har waqt banne ki koshish karta raha.

Aur shayad... yeh bhi ek

beginning hai.

.

"

CHAPTER 11

THE DAY I STOPPED FEELING SORRY FOR MYSELF

Mujhe exact din yaad nahi hai.

Bas itna yaad hai ki ek din main wahi purani story kisi ko suna raha tha.

Wahi story jo main pehle bhi suna chuka tha.

Khud ko bhi.

Dusron ko bhi.

Apne dimaag ko toh shayad sau baar.

Aur beech mein achanak mujhe laga... main yeh sab pehle bhi bol chuka hu.

Har line.

Har explanation.

Har reason.

Kuch naya nahi tha.

Bas dard purana tha.

Aur words naye the.

Us realization ne mujhe uncomfortable kar diya.

Kyunki pehli baar mujhe laga...

shayad main answer nahi dhoond raha.

Shayad main bas wahi room baar baar visit kar raha hu
Mujhe yaad hai kitni baar

maine socha:

"Bas ek baar aur soch leta hu."

Jaise iss baar kuch alag mil jayega.

Lekin har baar main wahi lekar wapas aata tha.

Wahi memory.

Wahi regret.

Wahi questions.

Aur dheere dheere mujhe ek aur cheez samajh aayi.

Main sirf hurt nahi tha.

Main hurt rehne ka aadat wala ho gaya tha.

Yeh line mujhe khud pasand nahi.

Lekin shayad sach thi.

Kyunki ek waqt ke baad... dard

familiar lagne laga tha.

Aur familiar cheezein ajeeb tareeke se

comfortable hoti hain

Chahe woh tumhe destroy hi kyun na kar rahi ho

Main hurt rehne ka aadat wala ho gaya tha.

Yeh line mujhe khud pasand nahi.

Lekin shayad sach thi.

Kyunki ek waqt ke baad... dard
familiar lagne laga tha.
Aur familiar cheezein ajeeb tareeke se comfortable hoti
hain.
Chahe woh tumhe destroy hi kyun na kar rahi ho.
Mujhe lagta tha main apne past ko samajhne ki koshish
kar raha hu.
Lekin agar poori honesty se bolu...
toh shayad mera ek part usse chhodna hi nahi chahta tha.
Kyunki phir mere paas bachega kya?
Maine itna time us story ke saath spend kiya tha... ki woh
story meri identity banne lagi thi.
Logon ko nahi pata tha.
Lekin mujhe pata tha.
Har baar jab main akela hota tha...
mera dimaag automatically wahi chala jaata tha.
Jaise kisi ne default setting set kar di ho.
Aur sabse dangerous baat?
Main usse stop bhi nahi karta tha.
Kyunki mujhe lagta tha main healing kar raha hu.
Aaj lagta hai...
main sirf repeat kar raha tha.

Ek hi chapter.

Ek hi scene.

Ek hi feeling.

Bas alag alag dinon mein....

Ek raat maine genuinely khud se poocha:

Agar kal subah uthkar sab pain gayab ho gaya...

toh kya hoga?

Aur jo answer aaya...

woh mujhe pasand nahi aaya.

Kyunki mere dimaag ne pehle pain ke jaane ke baare mein nahi socha.

Usne socha:

"Phir main rahunga kaun?"

Main kuch minute tak chup baitha raha.

Kyunki pehli baar mujhe realise hua... main sirf pain carry nahi kar raha tha.

Main usse apne saath attach kar chuka tha.

Jaise woh mera part ho.

Jaise uske bina main adhura ho jaunga.

Aur wahi moment tha jab mujhe darr laga.

Situation se nahi.

Past se nahi.

Memory se nahi
Main usse apne saath attach kar chuka tha.
Jaise woh mera part ho.
Jaise uske bina main adhura ho jaunga.
Aur wahi moment tha jab mujhe darr laga.
Situation se nahi.
Past se nahi.
Memory se nahi.
Khud se.
Kyunki mujhe pehli baar laga...
ki kahin main unknowingly apne hi cage ka door pakad
kar khada hu.
Aur bahar nikalne se mana bhi main hi kar raha hu.
Us raat kuch change nahi hua.
Main suddenly better nahi ho gaya.
Main strong bhi feel nahi kar raha tha.
Bas ek illusion toot gaya.
Woh illusion ki main heal kar raha hu...
jabki main sirf repeat kar raha tha.
Aur shayad wahi pehli baar tha...
jab maine apne aap par taras khana thoda kam kiya.
Aur apne aap ko observe karna thoda zyada.

Main suddenly better nahi ho gaya.
Main strong bhi feel nahi kar raha tha.
Bas ek illusion toot gaya.
Woh illusion ki main heal kar raha hu...
jabki main sirf repeat kar raha tha.
Aur shayad wahi pehli baar tha...
jab maine apne aap par taras khana thoda kam kiya.
Aur apne aap ko observe karna thoda zyada.
Kyunki us point ke baad sawaal yeh nahi tha:
"Mere saath yeh kyun hua?"
Sawaal yeh tha:
"Ab main iske saath aur kitna time jeene wala hu?"
Aur sach kahu...
mere paas uska answer aaj bhi nahi hai.
Lekin pehli baar...
maine answer dhoondhne se zyada... sawaal se
bhaagna band kiya.

CHAPTER 12

THE QUIET I STARTED LIVING WITH

Pehle mujhe lagta tha main overthink karta hu.

Phir mujhe laga main sirf feel karta hu.

Phir dheere dheere mujhe samajh aaya... main
bas chup rehna seekh gaya hu.

Shor kam nahi hua tha.

Bas andar shift ho gaya tha.

Log sochte hain silence ka matlab peace hota hai.

Mere case mein aisa nahi tha.

Mera silence peaceful nahi tha.

Mera silence tired tha.

Jaise kisi cheez ko explain karne ki energy hi khatam ho
gayi ho.

Pehle main har cheez analyze karta tha.

Har message.

Har pause.

Har tone.

Phir ek point aaya... jab main analyze karna bhi
postpone karne laga.

Not because I understood everything.
But because I stopped caring enough to solve it.
Aur yeh difference mujhe bahut der baad samajh aaya.
Understanding aur numbness same nahi hote.
Main samajh raha tha ki main theek ho raha hu.
Lekin shayad main sirf feel karna kam kar raha tha.
Kabhi kabhi main apne aap ko observe karta hu.
Main kisi cheez ka reaction nahi deta.
Na khushi.
Na sadness.
Na anger.
Bas ek blank response.
Aur pehle mujhe lagta tha yeh maturity hai.
Aaj lagta hai yeh thakan hai.
Ek aisi thakan jahan tumhe kuch feel karne ke liye bhi
permission chahiye hoti hai.
Main logo se normal baat karta hu.
Main smile karta hu.
Main reply deta hu.
Sab kuch normal lagta hai.
Lekin andar kuch bhi fully present nahi hota.
Jaise main life ko participate nahi kar raha.

Bas usko observe kar raha hu.
Aur kabhi kabhi mujhe darr lagta hai.
Ki main iss state mein itna comfortable na ho jaun... ki
wapas feel karna hi ajeeb lagne lage.
Kyunki numbness bhi ek habit ban sakti hai.
Aur habits quietly dangerous hoti hain.
Woh tumhe todti nahi hain.
Woh tumhe slowly change kar deti hain.
Mujhe yaad hai ek din maine khud se poocha...
“Main kya ban raha hu?”
Aur mere paas answer nahi tha.
Sirf ek silence tha.
Lekin woh silence pehle jaisa nahi tha.
Pehle silence mein sawal hote the.
Ab silence mein sirf space tha.
Empty space.
Kabhi kabhi main kisi purani baat ko yaad karta hu... aur
mujhe
lagta hai main us insaan ko jaanta hi nahi tha.
Jo itna feel karta tha.
Jo itna react karta tha.
Jo har cheez ko apne andar le leta tha.

Woh version ab door lagta hai.
Lekin gayab nahi.
Bas inaccessible.
Jaise koi purani file jiska password bhool gaya ho.
Main ab bhi zindagi jee raha hu.
Lekin ek difference ke saath.
Main ab zindagi ke andar fully sink nahi karta.
Main thoda bahar hi rehta hu.
Aur shayad ye protection hai.
Ya phir avoidance.
Mujhe khud bhi nahi pata.
Kabhi kabhi main sochta hu... ki agar main apne
aap ko fully feel karne du... toh kya main wapas
wahi chaos mein chala jaunga?
Ya phir shayad main sirf us chaos ka darr carry kar raha
hu.
Main sure nahi hu.
Aur shayad yahi problem hai.
Main sure hona hi chhod chuka hu.
Main bas exist kar raha hu.
Quietly.
Without asking too many questions.

Without expecting answers.

Aur kabhi kabhi lagta hai... yeh
peace nahi hai.

Yeh pause hai.

Long pause.

PHASE IV

BECOMING SOMEONE

***THE SILENCE COULD NO
LONGER HIDE***

CHAPTER 13

THE DISTANCE

I DIDN'T NOTICE GROWING

Kabhi kabhi mujhe lagta hai... main apni hi
zindagi se thoda peeche ho gaya hu.

Jaise main ab uska part nahi... sirf
ek observer ho.

Pehle main har cheez ke beech hota tha.

Har emotion ke andar.

Har situation ke center mein.

Ab main bas side se dekh raha hu.

Log baat karte hain.

Main sunta hu.

Log react karte hain.

Main notice karta hu.

Lekin andar se kuch trigger nahi hota.

Aur yeh baat mujhe pehle ajeeb lagti thi.

Ab normal lagne lagi hai.

Shayad isi ko log control bolte hain.

Ya shayad disconnect.

Mujhe khud bhi clear nahi.

Kabhi kabhi main kisi cheez par react karna chahta hu...

Lekin reaction aata hi nahi.

Jaise beech mein koi invisible gap aa gaya ho... mere
aur life ke beech.

Main us gap ko explain nahi kar sakta.

Bas feel kar sakta hu.

Aur woh feeling bhi half hi hoti hai.

Main purane version ko yaad karta hu... toh
woh mujhe real lagta hai.

Aur main jo ab hu... woh temporary
lagta hai.

Jaise main kisi transition phase mein atak gaya hu.

Na pura wahan.

Na pura yahan.

Kabhi kabhi mujhe lagta hai... main apne emotions ko door
se observe karna seekh gaya hu.

Jaise woh kisi aur ke hon.

Aur shayad yeh hi survival hai.

Kyunki agar main har cheez ko pehle jaisa feel karu... toh
shayad main handle hi na kar paun.

Lekin ek sawaal kabhi kabhi aata hai.

Agar main itna door ho gaya hu... toh main ab “main”
kitna hu?

Ya main sirf ek habit hu... jo chal
rahi hai bina full presence ke.

Kabhi kabhi main khud ko test karta hu.

Koi purani memory yaad karta hu.

Dekhta hu reaction aata hai ya nahi.

Aur kabhi aata hai... kabhi
nahi aata.

Aur dono hi cheezein mujhe confuse karti hain.

Reaction aana bhi strange lagta hai.

Reaction na aana bhi.

Jaise main apne hi system ko samajh nahi paa raha.

Log kehte hain “you’ve changed.”

Main kehta hu “haan shayad.”

Lekin sach yeh hai... main nahi jaanta change hua hu ya
sirf distant ho gaya hu.

Aur yeh difference mujhe darata bhi nahi... bas
thaka deta hai.

Kabhi kabhi main sochta hu... ki agar main kisi din
completely feel karna shuru kar du... toh kya main wapas
wahi

ho jaunga jo main tha?

Ya phir main itna door aa chuka hu... ki

wapas jaana possible hi nahi hai.

Main jawab nahi jaanta.

Aur shayad isi liye main questions kam poochne laga hu.

Kyunki har question ek aur layer khol deta hai... jahan main already thoda lost hu.

Ab main zyada zindagi ko explain nahi karta.

Main bas usko observe karta hu.

Jaise koi cheez jo mere saath ho rahi hai... lekin mere andar nahi.

Aur kabhi kabhi mujhe lagta hai...

yeh peace nahi hai.

Yeh distance hai.

Aur distance hamesha visible nahi hota.

Woh slowly build hota hai.

Bina noise ke.

Bina warning ke.

Bas ek din tum realize karte ho... ki

tum wahan nahi ho jahan pehle the.

Aur shayad wahi din... sabse

confusing hota hai.

CHAPTER 14

WHEN EVEN MY SILENCE STARTED SOUNDING FAKE

Mujhe ek din achanak yeh doubt aaya...

ki main jo shaant lagta hu... kya main
waise hi hu?

Ya main sirf aisa dikh raha hu?

Pehle yeh question nahi aata tha.

Ab yeh question zyada aata hai.

Aur iska answer kabhi nahi aata.

Main baat karta hu.

Normal.

Theek.

Controlled.

Lekin beech beech mein ek thought disturb karta hai... ki
main jo bol raha hu... kya main usme hu bhi?

Ya bas keh raha hu?

Kabhi kabhi main khud ko observe karta hu... ki
main kaise behave kar raha hu.

Aur phir ruk jaata hu.

Kyunki ek aur layer aa jaati hai.

Main sochta hu...

“main observe kar raha hu apne aap ko.”

Aur uss moment pe thoda ajeeb lagta hai.

Kyuki agar main observer hu... toh phir main
kaun hu jo observe ho raha hai?

Main?

Ya koi aur version?

Kabhi kabhi mujhe lagta hai...

apne hi andar shift ho gaya hu.

Ek aisa shift jahan main fully present nahi hu.

Bas thoda sa available hu.

Baaki autopilot hai.

Main kisi se baat karta hu... aur beech mein mujhe
lagta hai... ki yeh conversation mere through ja
rahi hai... mujh mein se nahi aa
rahi.

Aur main us moment ko explain nahi karta.

Bas ignore kar deta hu.

Jaise ignore karna aadat ban gaya ho.

Log kehte hain main calm ho gaya hu.

Mujhe pata nahi woh compliment hai ya warning.
Kyuki calm hone aur feel kam hone mein ek line hoti hai...
aur
mujhe nahi pata main kis side pe hu.
Kabhi kabhi main apni hi awaaz sunta hu... aur
lagta hai woh thodi door se aa rahi hai.
Jaise main apne andar nahi bol raha... main
apne bahar se bol raha hu.
Main apni life ko jeeta nahi hu... main
uske saath adjust karta hu.
Aur yeh adjust karna dheere dheere normal ban gaya hai.
Main khud se poochta
hu... “main abhi yahan hu bhi?”
Aur answer nahi hota.
Bas silence hota hai.
Lekin pehle jaisa silence nahi.
Ab silence mein sawaal nahi hote.
Bas gap hota hai.
Main nahi jaanta yeh kya hai.
Disconnect.
Ya protection.
Ya kuch aur.

Bas itna pata hai... ki main har cheez ko feel karne se
pehle samajhne laga hu.

Aur samajhna kabhi kabhi feel ko ruk deta hai.

Main ab bhi zindagi mein hu.

Lekin poori tarah nahi.

Aur shayad yeh sabse ajeeb part hai.

Ki main khud se bhi fully sure nahi hu.

CHAPTER 15

THE VERSION OF ME THAT DOESN'T FIT ANYMORE

Mujhe lagta hai main ab us insaan jaisa nahi raha jo main
pehle tha.

Par ajeeb baat yeh hai... main usse poori
tarah chhod bhi nahi paaya.

Jaise koi purani skin ho...

jo ab tight ho gayi ho... par
utarti bhi nahi.

Kabhi kabhi main khud ko yaad karta hu.

Aur mujhe lagta hai...

“haan, main aisa tha.”

Lekin turant baad lagta hai...

“ya shayad main kabhi tha hi nahi.”

Dono thoughts ek saath chalte hain.

Aur dono hi mujhe confuse nahi karte ab.

Bas thoda sa empty kar dete hain.

Main pehle zyada react karta tha.

Chhoti chhoti cheezein.

Log

Messages.

Silence.

Presence.

Absence.

Ab kuch bhi directly hit nahi karta.

Aur pehle mujhe lagta tha yeh progress hai.

Ab lagta hai... main bas thoda kam
available ho gaya hu.

Main kisi se milta hu...

baat karta hu... smile bhi
karta hu...

Lekin beech beech mein ek gap hota hai.

Jaise main poori tarah wahan nahi hu.

Main observe karta hu apne aap ko.

Ki main kaise react kar raha hu.

Aur phir sochta hu...

“kya yeh main hu?”

“kya yeh main hu?”

Aur jawab nahi aata.

Bas ek purani si memory aati hai... jab
main cheezein feel karta tha bina soche.

Ab main sochta hu pehle...

feel baad mein aata hai... ya

kabhi kabhi aata hi nahi.

Main kisi cheez ko miss karta hu... lekin us missing
ka intensity bhi change ho gaya hai

Jaise koi cheez door ho...

par us door hone ka dard bhi dheere dheere fade ho gaya
ho.

Aur mujhe samajh nahi aata... yeh
healing hai ya loss ka next stage.

Kabhi kabhi main khud ko force karta hu... feel
karne ke liye.

Purani yaadein.

Purane moments.

Purane emotions.

Lekin woh wapas nahi aate.

Sirf ek faint echo aata hai.

Jaise koi awaaz jo kisi aur room se aa rahi ho.

Main ab bhi wahi insaan hu... jo
sochta hai. jo samajhta hai. jo
chal raha hai.

Lekin woh urgency nahi rahi.

Woh intensity nahi rahi.

Woh “everything matters” wala feel dheere dheere kam ho gaya hai.

Aur mujhe darr nahi lagta is baat se.

Bas main notice karta hu.

Ki main kisi cheez ke andar poori tarah doob nahi pa raha.

Main hamesha thoda bahar hi reh jaata hu.

Jaise main life ko live nahi kar raha... main usse read kar raha hu.

Aur kabhi kabhi mujhe lagta hai... shayad main ab kisi ek fixed version mein fix hogya hu

mai har jagah thoda sa mismatch

Log ke saath bhi.

Khud ke saath bhi.

Aur yeh mismatch painful nahi hai.

Bas real hai.

Main ab kisi purane version ko wapas laane ki koshish nahi karta.

Kyunki mujhe pata hai... woh

wapas nahi aayega. Aur shayad main

bhi nahi jaa sakta us taraf.

Toh main bas yahin hu.

Thoda changed.

Thoda absent.

Thoda aware.

Aur shayad isi ko log growing up bolte hain.

Ya shayad kuch aur.

Mujhe nahi pata.

Bas itna pata hai... ki main ab woh nahi hu jo main yaad karta hu.

Aur shayad... yeh hi end of something hai.

Aur start of something else.

CHAPTER 16

I DON'T KNOW IF THIS EVER ENDED

Mujhe nahi pata yeh sab kab start hua tha.

Aur ab jab main yeh likh raha hu...

mujhe yeh bhi nahi pata... ki yeh

kab khatam ho raha hai.

Shayad kuch cheezein end nahi hoti.

Bas dheere dheere fade ho jaati hain.

Main pehle sochta tha... har story

ka ek ending hota hai.

Clear.

Defined.

Final.

Lekin ab lagta hai... kuch stories sirf

shape change karti hain.

Disappear nahi hoti.

Main ab bhi wahi hu...

jo sochta hai.

jo feel karta hai... .

jo kabhi kabhi. observe karta hai.

Lekin woh “main” jaisa pehle lagta
tha... woh ab thoda distant hai.
Jaise main khud ko kisi aur ke through dekh raha hu.
Aur kabhi kabhi mujhe lagta hai... ki
shayad main kabhi fully present tha
hi nahi.
Ya shayad
tha... aur
mujhe yaad
nahi.
Main kisi se yeh sab explain nahi karta.
Kyunki explain karne se cheezein heavy ho jaati hain.
Aur main already heavy feel nahi karta.
Main bas... hoon.
Aur yeh “hoona” bhi kabhi kabhi ajeeb lagta hai.
Na khushi.
Na sadness.
Bas ek ongoing state.
.
Jaise kuch complete nahi hua.
Par break bhi nahi hua.
Main apne purane versions ko yaad karta

hu... lekin unko wapas bulaane ki koshish
nahi karta.

Kyunki mujhe pata hai... woh
already kisi aur jagah exist kar
rahe hain.

Aur main yahan hu.

Alag.

Thoda quiet.

Thoda empty.

Thoda aware.

Kabhi kabhi mujhe lagta hai... ki
main apni hi story ka reader ban
gaya hu.

Writer nahi.

Sirf reader

Jo pages palat raha
hai... lekin end
dhundh nahi raha.

Aur shayad yahi problem thi.

Main end dhoondh raha tha.

Jabki kuch cheezein end ke liye bani hi nahi hoti.

Bas continue hoti hain.

In a different form.

Main nahi jaanta main theek hu ya nahi.

Aur shayad yeh sawaal ab matter bhi nahi karta.

Kyunki ab main answers ke liye nahi jeeta.

Main bas moments ke through guzar raha hu.

Quietly.

Without needing them to mean something every time.

Agar koi mujhse pooche...

“kya hua?”

Main shayad kuch nahi bolunga.

Ya shayad bolunga:

“kuch nahi... aur sab kuch.”

Aur shayad wahi sach hoga.

Some things don't end.

They just become quieter over time.

I don't know if this was a story.

Or just a phase that kept repeating itself in different forms.

Maybe nothing was meant to be solved here.

Maybe everything was only meant to be noticed.

And maybe that is all there ever is.

Not answers.

Not endings.

Just awareness that something changed...
without ever announcing itself.

If there is a final
feeling left, it is not
clarity.

It is not peace.

It is simply this:

Somewhere along the way, I stopped searching for an end.

I thought I was losing myself

I thought I was losing all the memories

Losing of every moments

Losing of every connections.

I don't know if this was a story.
Or just a phase that kept repeating itself in different forms.
Maybe nothing was meant to be solved here.
Maybe everything was only meant to be noticed.
And maybe that is all there ever is.
Not answers.
Not endings.
Just awareness that something changed... without
ever announcing itself.
If there is a final feeling left, it
is not clarity.
It is not peace.
It is simply this:
Somewhere along the way, I stopped searching for an end.
I thought I was afraid of
losing myself.
Turns out, I was afraid of meeting myself
~ THE QUIET I STARTED LIVING WITH

END REALIZATION

Simply Inside It

I used to think I was trying to understand myself.

But I wasn't.

I was trying to complete unfinished thoughts about myself.

There is a difference between understanding and completion.

Understanding expands. Completion tries to close.

For a long time, I lived without noticing that difference.

Every thought felt necessary.

Every memory felt incomplete.

Every silence felt like something missing.

I did not experience life directly.

I experienced it through constant interpretation.

And slowly, interpretation replaced experience.

I replayed what was already over.

Reconstructed what could no longer change.

Assigned meaning to fragments the mind refused to release.

It felt like awareness.

But it was repetition mistaken for insight.

The mind has a quiet tendency:

what is revisited often starts to feel significant,
and what feels significant begins to feel true.
That is how repetition becomes identity—without ever
becoming truth.
I thought I was remembering my life.
I was editing it, in real time.
Memory is never fixed.
It is rebuilt each time it is recalled.
And it is rebuilt from the present, not the past.
Fear reshapes it.
Regret reshapes it.
Expectation reshapes it.
So what I carried was never what happened.
Only my current interpretation of what happened.
And I called that “me.”
There was no decisive moment of change.
No collapse.
No clarity.
No revelation.
Only a gradual reduction of urgency.
The need to resolve every thought slowly weakened.
At first, that felt wrong.

Because constant mental activity had become normal.
Stillness felt like something missing.
But nothing was missing.
There was only space where reaction used to be.
And for a while, I almost filled it again out of habit.
But the pattern broke when I noticed something simple:
Not every thought requires continuation.
Not every memory requires meaning.
Not every feeling requires interpretation.
Some things exist only to pass through awareness.
That realization did not stop thoughts.
It changed my relationship with them.
Thoughts were no longer instructions.
Memories were no longer demands.
Feelings were no longer problems to solve.
They became events.
Temporary. Impersonal. Passing.
This was not immediately peaceful.
It felt like loss at first.
Loss of internal narration.
Loss of constant engagement.

Loss of the sense that I was always “working through something.”

But even that loss dissolved.

What remained was distance.

A separation between what happens and what I make of it.

That separation is everything.

Because thoughts no longer define the space they appear in.

They move through it.

And the space remains unchanged.

I did not create that stillness.

I stopped interfering with it.

And in that absence of interference, something became clear:

Nothing inside needed correction in the way I believed.

Only observation without control.

When control dropped, the mind stopped behaving like a problem.

It became movement.

Not identity.

Not truth.

Not command.

Just movement.

And the ground beneath it was always here.
Unchanged. Unaffected.
I had mistaken movement for self.
That mistake ended quietly.
Not through resolution.
But through the disappearance of the need for resolution.
Now, thoughts still arise.
But they no longer determine where I stand.
I am no longer inside every thought.
I can see them pass without entering them.
And for the first time, I am not trying to explain my life.
I am simply inside it.
And that is all.

EPILOGUE

What Remained After the Noise

In the end, nothing dramatic changed.

There was no final moment where everything suddenly made sense.

No clear ending where the mind went silent forever.

Life continued in the same ordinary way it always had.

But something subtle had shifted in how it was being lived.

The thoughts were still there.

They still arrived uninvited, still repeated themselves, still tried to complete unfinished things.

But they no longer felt like directions.

Only movements.

Passing through.

Without ownership.

I stopped treating every thought as a message.

Stopped assuming every inner sentence required an answer.

Some questions were still unanswered.

They remained unanswered.

And strangely, nothing collapsed because of it.

There was a time I believed clarity meant resolution.

That peace meant solving everything inside the mind.
Now it felt different.
Peace was not resolution.
It was distance.
Not escape.
Not suppression.
Just a quiet separation between what is experienced... and
what is narrated.
There were still moments when the old pattern returned.
A conversation replaying itself.
A memory reshaping its tone.
A future being rewritten in advance.
But something in me no longer followed it all the way.
The loop could continue.
But I did not have to live inside it.
That was the change I never expected.
Not silence.
But space.
Space between thought and identity.
Between interpretation and truth.
Between what happens... and what is made of what
happens.

I used to think I was trapped inside my mind.
Now I see it differently.
The mind was never a prison.
It was only a place I forgot I could stand beside instead of
inside.
Nothing external resolved itself.
No past was corrected.
No version of events was restored to purity.
Everything remained imperfectly remembered.
And that was enough.
Because the need to perfect it slowly stopped feeling
necessary.
There is a quiet kind of ending that does not announce
itself.
It does not close a story.
It simply removes the urgency to continue rewriting it.
Even now, silence is not absolute.
It never became total.
It simply stopped needing to be defined.
Sometimes it is still interrupted by thought.
Sometimes by memory.
Sometimes by nothing at all.

But none of it feels like disturbance anymore.
Only weather.
Passing through an unchanged sky.
If there is something I understand now, it is this:
Nothing was ever waiting to be fixed inside me.
Only observed.
And when observation stopped trying to become control...
something unnecessary fell away on its own.
Not the mind.
But the need to believe everything it said.
That is what remained.
Not answers.
Not resolution.
Not final understanding.
Just a quieter relationship with thought.
And perhaps that is the closest thing to silence there ever
was.
Not the absence of noise.
But the absence of resistance to it.
And in that absence...
life was always here.
It had never left.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Lalit R. Mishra is a student who began writing out of curiosity rather than ambition.

What started as scattered notes, unfinished thoughts, and observations gradually turned into stories

that explored experiences difficult to capture in ordinary conversations.

He is less interested in giving answers and more interested in paying attention to the questions

people carry with them.

His work is influenced by everyday moments, long periods of reflection, and the belief that some

of the most meaningful experiences in life are often the hardest to describe.

"The Quiet I Started Living With" is his second book.